

In Excel, **comments** (now often referred to as **Notes** or **Threaded Comments** in modern versions) are essential for adding context, reminders, or feedback to specific cells without altering the actual data content.

1. Types of Comments

- **Threaded Comments:** These allow for "conversations" within a cell. You can reply to a comment, making it ideal for collaborative projects like the **IBM SkillsBuild Summer Internship Program** or group engineering assignments where multiple people review the same sheet.
- **Notes:** These are the classic yellow boxes used for simple annotations or reminders. They are non-threaded and stay attached to the cell as a static "sticky note."

2. Managing Comments and Notes

- **Adding a Comment:** Right-click a cell and select **New Comment** or **New Note**. Alternatively, use the shortcut **Shift + F2**.
- **Identifying Commented Cells:** A small **colored triangle** (usually red for notes or purple for threaded comments) appears in the top-right corner of the cell to indicate that a comment exists.
- **Editing and Deleting:** You can modify the text by right-clicking the cell and choosing **Edit Comment/Note**, or remove it entirely using **Delete Comment/Note**.

3. Reviewing Comments

- **Hover to View:** Simply hover your mouse over the cell with the indicator to see the note or comment pop up.
- **Review Tab:** Use the **Review** tab in the ribbon to navigate through all comments in a workbook using "Next" and "Previous" buttons.
- **Show All Notes:** In the **Review** tab, you can toggle **Show All Notes** to keep every note visible simultaneously, which is helpful when checking for errors in a large **Salary statement** or **Sales chart**.

4. Practical Use Cases in Engineering Data

- **Formula Explanation:** Use a note to explain the logic of a complex **INDEX and MATCH** or **Nested IF** function so other users understand how the calculation works.
- **Data Source Attribution:** When you **Import data**, use a comment to note the original file path or the date the data was last refreshed.
- **Audit Trail:** In a **Cybersecurity Based Secure Voting System** or financial model, comments can track who made a specific change and why, providing a manual "log" for the spreadsheet.

- **Error Handling:** If a cell shows an error like #N/A, you can add a note explaining that the value is missing from the **Lookup function** source range and needs to be updated.

5. Printing Comments

When using **Printing options**, you can choose how comments appear on the physical page:

- **As displayed on sheet:** Prints the notes exactly where they appear over the grid.
- **At end of sheet:** Prints a separate list of all comments and their cell references on a final page.